tweets classified as “populist-style” given the total number of tweets per year. Points represent month–year averages.

7.4.2 Twitter Engagement Regression Results

We investigate whether tweets classified as populist-style garner greater public engagement compared with other IO tweets. Engagement is measured through likes and retweets, which serve as proxies for public approval and resonance with messaging strategies on social media.

Our primary analysis employs ordinary least squares with robust standard errors. To account for institutional differences, we include IO-fixed effects in all specifications. We further control for additional tweet characteristics that might influence engagement by including a dummy variable to denote whether a given tweet includes a photograph or video attachment as well as sentiment scores assessing whether the tone of the language is relatively positive or negative for each tweet, calculated using the NRC Word-Emotion Association Lexicon. Such covariates allow us to account for stylistic features of the tweet that might drive engagement, as opposed to populist-style rhetoric.

TABLE 7.2. Twitter engagement

	Dependent variable					
	Likes (1)	**RTs (2)**	**Likes (3)**	**RTs (4)**	**Likes (5)**	**RTs (6)**
Populist-style	0.096***	0.111***	0.087***	0.110***	0.051***	0.079***
	(0.012)	(0.011)	(0.011)	(0.011)	(0.011)	(0.011)
Media			0.593***	0.539***	0.556***	0.469***
			(0.009)	(0.009)	(0.009)	(0.009)
Sentiment			−0.00000	−0.028***	0.0004	−0.016***
			(0.004)	(0.004)	(0.004)	(0.004)
Constant	1.134***	2.581***	1.124***	2.584***	1.281***	2.744***
	(0.040)	(0.047)	(0.040)	(0.047)	(0.040)	(0.044)

Note: Model type is OLS with IO and month–year fixed effects. Standard errors are robust. We add one to zeros and log likes and RTs before proceeding with the analysis.
***p <.01; **p <.05; *p <.1